

OTHERS BUILD

Four other sovereign AI models were lau

ly low cost and limited GPUs, is a significant achievement.”

Bindra cautions against directly comparing Indian models with global leaders such as GPT-4, Gemini, Claude, or DeepSeek purely on size or completeness. “The point is not how large the model is. The real achievement is that India now has sovereign capability—of whatever scale—built in-house. That is strategically important.”

What stands out is Sarvam’s approach of building beyond just a foundation model, he says. Alongside the core models, the company has launched a conversational interface, Indus, as well as edge AI capabilities designed to run on devices. For a country such as India, such smaller, application-focused models that work offline or with limited connectivity could be far more relevant than large, general-purpose systems.

The company has also introduced applied capabilities, including vision/OCR, text-to-speech, and hardware experiments such as smart glasses Sarvam Kaze, signalling a shift towards real-world deployment. OCR stands for optical character recognition.

Bindra says the focus remains firmly on Indian use cases, Indic languages, and sector-specific applications. His only concern is the scale of resources available. India’s sovereign AI efforts are being pursued under tight financial and infrastructure constraints, he says. Even Sarvam’s training cluster, about 4,000 GPUs, is modest by global standards. “Sometimes we take too much pride in frugality,” he says. “These are (companies that have built LLMs in India) small teams doing remarkable work. With the right level of capital and compute, they could operate at a different scale and become far more relevant



Ganesh Gopalan, CEO, Gnani.ai

Gnani.ai unveiled major advances in voice technology, including Vachana TTS for human-like text-to-speech in 12 Indic languages, and Inya TT, a foundational text-to-speech model delivering human-quality speech synthesis with zero-shot voice cloning capability (zero-shot voice cloning can operate with just a short audio sample of the target speaker’s voice—sometimes as brief as a few seconds). The company serves over 200 enterprises, powering tens of millions of daily voice interactions.

CEO Ganesh Gopalan says voice AI in Indian languages has shifted from experimental to mission critical. Its models are built to handle accents, dialects, and code-mixed speech, though true AI self-reliance will require stronger compute infrastructure and long-term capital.



Ganesh Ramakrishnan, Principal Investigator, BharatGen

At the India AI Impact Summit 2026, BharatGen unveiled a 17-billion parameter sovereign, multilingual foundation model designed to support 22 Indian languages with multimodal capabilities. Developed under the broader PARAM-2 initiative, the model aims to reduce India’s dependence on foreign AI systems and

strengthen domestic technological control.

BharatGen was the largest beneficiary in the third tranche of the IndiaAI Mission, receiving ₹989 crore. It has brought together leading academic and research institutions, including IIT Bombay, IIT Madras, IIIT Hyderabad, IIT Kanpur, IIT Hyderabad, IIT Mandi, IIM Indore, IIIT Delhi, and IIT Kharagpur, creating a collaborative ecosystem of researchers, academia, government, and industry to build indigenous AI capability and secure India’s AI future.

for India’s enterprise ecosystem.”

So, how will Sarvam compete globally? Bindra says one should not focus on whether the home-grown models will be used outside India or not as “maybe with their capabilities, they can make something for some of the other countries of the Global South that require frugal engineering and pricing. We should focus on build-

ing a huge number of applications on top that are used not only in India but also elsewhere.”

But what about enterprise adoption? According to Hemant Mohapatra, Partner at Lightspeed India Partners, also an investor in Sarvam, enterprise AI adoption in India is at an early stage. “Enterprise spending on AI is extremely small, perhaps tens of millions of dollars, and low